

also the first OS to have an “in with the new and out with the old” approach as Apple dropped support for the original iPhone and iPod Touch. Till this point, the iPhone OS was a paid upgrade for the iPod. You’d have to shell out \$9.95 for the upgrade if you owned an iPod but that changed with iOS 4. The very first iDevice with Retina Display made its debut and developers now had to create multiple assets for the different viewports. Essentially, the same visual assets had to be created for different DPI levels, something that has since then become automated. Other additions include notifications, background completion of tasks, a unified mailbox and multiple folders for the home screen.

- **iOS 5**

Siri, Apple’s personal assistant was introduced with iOS 5 and it also brought the iMessage and iCloud services. Support for the 2nd Gen iPhone was dropped and the 2nd Gen iPad was introduced. You could now customise the notification centre and iTunes could sync wirelessly.

- **iOS 6**

This was yet another major release with regards to the number of devices now being supported as well as the number of features that were introduced. The third and fourth gen iPads along with the iPad mini came into the picture along with the iPhone 5. The infamous Apple Maps was released with iOS 6 as well, and thus began an incessant barrage of memes highlighting Apple Maps’ goof-ups along the way. Apple Maps has considerably improved over the years so those memes can officially be put in the dank bin now. Other notable improvements included Panorama Photos, a Do Not Disturb mode, FaceTime over cellular networks and the integration of a Facebook API into the core OS.

- **iOS 7**

The biggest change with iOS design was its departure from the skeuomorphic design philosophy towards a more flatter design. Apple still retained gradients on its app icons but the overall change was starkly different from everything prior to that release. A lot more elements of the UI became translucent. All of these changes, were quite frankly, a breath of fresh air for an OS that had retained its look for 7 whole years. New features and apps introduced include AirDrop, an additional Control Center, new Photos app and iTunes Radio.